

Report on the outcomes of a presentation and participation in a ITC Conference¹

Action number: CA21129 - What are Opinions? Integrating Theory and Methods for Automatically Analyzing Opinionated Communication (OPINION)

Grantee name: Ardita Reçi

Conference Details

Conference title: **COMPTXT 2026**, 8th Annual Conference on Computational Text Analysis, University of Birmingham · 23–25 April 2026

Conference web-page: <https://www.comptextconference.org/8th-annual-conference-2026/>

Conference venue²: Teaching and Learning Building, University of Birmingham

Accepted contribution details

Title of the presentation: *Rethinking textual opinion research from a communication perspective*

Track of the conference programme in which the contribution was accepted:

Text, opinion, and measurement validity in communication research, held on Friday 24 April in the morning session, 10:30–12:00 · LG03 Seminar Room. This session included the following contributions:

Sjoerd Stolwijk; Anke Stoll; Damian Trilling: *When annotators make errors: Implications for downstream tasks involving language models*

Ardita Reçi: *Rethinking textual opinion research from a communication perspective*

Kyungmin Kim; John Tervovski: *Style over substance: Applying information theory to textual administrative data*

Outcome of the conference participation

Participation in the conference significantly enhanced the visibility of my research within the field of communication and textual opinion analysis. Through my presentation entitled “Rethinking Textual Opinion Research from a Communication Perspective”, I introduced a conceptual approach that challenges dominant data-driven models and emphasizes the role of discourse, context, and meaning-making processes in understanding opinion.

The presentation attracted interest from researchers working in related areas such as computational communication, discourse analysis, and media studies. The feedback received was constructive and focused particularly on the integration of communication theory with computational approaches, as well as the relevance of the proposed framework for low-resource contexts such as Albanian. This feedback will be valuable in further refining the theoretical and methodological aspects of my research.

In terms of networking, the conference provided an important opportunity to establish new professional contacts with researchers from different institutions and countries. Discussions were initiated regarding potential

¹ This report is submitted by the grantee to the Action MC for approval and for claiming payment of the awarded grant. The Grant Awarding Coordinator coordinates the evaluation of this report on behalf of the Action MC and instructs the Grant Holder Manager to verify the grant documents compliance and proceed with the payment.

² For an online conference, specify virtual participation; for hybrid conferences, specify whether it is an in-person or virtual participation.

collaboration in areas such as hybrid methodologies combining NLP and discourse analysis, as well as comparative studies across languages and media systems. These interactions have opened possibilities for future joint research activities, including co-authored publications and participation in international projects.

Furthermore, my participation contributed to increasing the visibility of the COST Action and its objectives. I actively promoted the Action during academic discussions, highlighting its focus on advancing textual opinion research through interdisciplinary collaboration and methodological innovation.

Overall, the conference participation was highly beneficial for strengthening my academic profile, expanding my research network, and creating opportunities for future collaboration aligned with the goals of the COST framework.

Acknowledgement of inclusion of necessary supporting documents to claim the grant

I confirm that the following documents have been uploaded on e-COST as an integral part of this report:

- the certificate of conference attendance issued by the conference organiser.
- the programme of the conference or book of abstracts / proceedings indicating the presentation (oral) of the grantee.